

EMILIA RUSSO

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I study how the design of digital technology presents both risks and opportunities for children's autonomy. I am particularly passionate about studying young children's digital gaming practices through playful, child-led design and research methods. At the University of Washington, I am a member of the [User Empowerment Lab](#), [GAMER Group](#), and [Center for Digital Youth](#).

EDUCATION

University of Washington, Seattle, WA 2024 - 2029

Doctor of Philosophy - Information Science

Advisor: [Alexis Hiniker](#)

Committee: [Alexis Hiniker](#) (chair), [Katie Davis](#), [Jason C. Yip](#), [Ariel Starr](#)

University of Washington, Seattle, WA 2024 - 2026

Master of Science - Information Science

The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL 2014 - 2018

Bachelor of Science - Computer Science

Bachelor of Arts with Honors - Psychology

Honors Thesis: Parents' Response Times Provide Implicit Negative Evidence for Grammar Learning

Readers: [Daniel Yurovsky](#) (advisor, primary investigator), [Susan Goldin-Meadow](#)

HONORS / AWARDS / FELLOWSHIPS

Connecting the EdTech Research EcoSystem (CERES) Scholar, Jacobs Foundation 2025, 2026

Provost Fellow, University of Washington 2024

"Earn Trust" Brightspot Award, Smartsheet 2023
< 0.1% company-wide

General Honors, The University of Chicago 2018

Honors in Psychology, The University of Chicago 2018

Outstanding Poster, Midwest Cognitive Science Conference 2018
Top 2 conference posters

Dean's List, The University of Chicago 2015, 2016, 2018

Grace Hopper Celebration Attendance Grant, Google 2015, 2016

Dean's Scholar, The University of Chicago 2014

Computer Science Summer Institute Participant, Google 2014

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Emilia Russo-Giometti, Nisha Devasia, and Alexis Hiniker. 2026. How Romantic Partners Build “Sound Relationship Houses” through Shared Gaming. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 10, 7, Article GAMES038 (November 2026), 36 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3831343>

POSTERS

Russo, E. & Hiniker, A. (2026, March). *Children's Understanding of Free-to-Play Digital Game Monetization Designs*. University of Washington Information School Research Fair. Seattle, WA.

Russo, E., Devasia, N., and Hiniker, A. (2026, March). *How Romantic Partners Build “Sound Relationship Houses” Through Shared Gaming*. University of Washington Information School Research Fair. Seattle, WA.

Russo, E. & Yurovsky, D. (2018, May). *Parents’ response times provide implicit negative evidence for grammar learning*. Midwestern Cognitive Science Conference. Bloomington, IN.

🏆 Outstanding Poster (top 2)

Russo, E. & Yurovsky, D. (2018, April). *Parents’ response times provide implicit negative evidence for grammar learning*. Chicago Area Undergraduate Research Symposium. Chicago, IL.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Communication and Learning Lab (CaLLab), The University of Chicago

Primary Investigator: Daniel Yurovsky

Undergraduate Honors Thesis Researcher

2016 - 2018

Infant Learning and Development Laboratory, The University of Chicago

Primary Investigator: Amanda Woodward

Undergraduate Research Assistant

2015 - 2016

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

HCID 530 A: Usability and User Research, University of Washington

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2026

INFO 498 A: User Experience Design for Games, University of Washington

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2026

INFO 498 B: Game Development for Social Good, University of Washington

Teaching Assistant

Winter 2026

INFO 498 C: Game Design for Social Good, University of Washington

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2025

INFO 356: Moral Reasoning and Interaction Design, University of Washington

Teaching Assistant

Winter 2025

INFO 300: Research Methods, University of Washington

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2024

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Brandfolder by Smartsheet, Denver, CO

Senior Software Engineer II

Summer 2024

Senior Software Engineer I

2021 - 2024

Full Stack Software Developer (Software Engineer II)

2019 - 2021

Microsoft, Redmond, WA

Software Engineer I

2018 - 2019

Square, San Francisco, CA

Software Engineer Intern - Developer Platform

Summer 2017

Google, Seattle, WA

Engineering Practicum Intern - Cloud Marketplace

Summer 2016

Google, Mountain View, CA

Engineering Practicum Intern - Knowledge Panel UI

Summer 2015

SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

iSchool PhD Committee Representative, University of Washington

2025 - 2027

Contract Action Team (CAT), UAW 4121

2025 - 2027

Election Committee Member, UAW 4121

2025 - 2027

iSchool Statement of Purpose Mentorship, University of Washington

2024, 2025

Giving Committee Member, Brandfolder by Smartsheet

2020 - 2024

Welcome Committee Member, Brandfolder

2019 - 2023

Performing Member, CHEER Seattle

2018 - 2019

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages + Frameworks

Proficient in: TypeScript/JavaScript, React, HTML + SCSS, Ruby on Rails, SQL

Exposure to: GDScript, JQuery, AngularJS, C, Python, Java, R, SML, XML

Platforms + Tools

Proficient in: Git, Unix (Bash scripting), Yarn/NPM, Google Cloud Build, PostgreSQL, Qualtrics, Smartsheet

Exposure to: Godot, Docker, Datadog, Mode, BigQuery, Firestore, Amazon Mechanical Turk, RStudio, PowerBI, Google Cloud Run, Google AppEngine, Firebase

Updated August 2026